

BEATRIZ GIETNER

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Office Contact Information

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Education

University College Dublin, Ph.D. in Economics	<i>2020–Present</i>
Trinity College Dublin, MEd. in Science Education	<i>2018</i>
Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina, Brazil, Lic. in Physics	<i>2013</i>
Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina, Brazil, BSc. in Physics	<i>2012</i>

References

Professor Kevin Denny (Supervisor) University College Dublin School of Economics kevin.denny@ucd.ie +353 (1) 716-4632	Professor Orla Doyle (Chair) University College Dublin School of Economics orla.doyle@ucd.ie +353 (1) 716-8677
Professor Paul Devereux University College Dublin School of Economics devereux@ucd.ie +353 (1) 716-8279	Professor Joseph Roche Trinity College Dublin School of Education joseph.roche@tcd.ie +353 (1) 896-4851

Research and Teaching Fields

Primary: Economics of Education
Secondary: Labour Economics, Econometrics & Machine Learning

The Dual Labour Market and the Motherhood Employment Penalty in Japan: Evidence from Household Panel Data

Abstract: Japan has among the most generous parental leave statutes in the OECD, yet one of the widest motherhood employment gaps. Using an event-study design applied to 662 first births in the JHPS and KHPS panels (2004–2022), I show that the penalty is strongly stratified by labour-market tier. Employment falls 13.2 percentage points at childbirth, with a clean near-lead null at $t = -2$. Among women employed before birth, non-regular contract status predicts non-employment at $t = 0$ with an odds ratio of 7.50 ($p < 0.001$), while the binary indicator for employers with fewer than 100 employees is positive but imprecise. Post-birth “recovery” is largely an extensive-margin illusion - returning mothers shift from full-time to part-time work, and conditional hours, earnings, and implied hourly wages remain durably below pre-birth levels. Government training subsidies designed to support re-entry face a three-layer access barrier: roughly half of mothers have never heard of the programme, and among those who are aware, most report being ineligible or unsure whether they qualify, consistent with the loss of employment-insurance-linked eligibility after childbirth exit. These patterns are consistent with weaker effective access to job-continuity protections in non-regular and sub-100-employer segments; statutory entitlements alone appear insufficient where labour-market dualism channels mothers into employment tiers with limited institutional support.

Working Papers

Cognitive Ability, Attentional Regulation, and Academic Achievement

Abstract: Research on educational production functions has established that cognitive and noncognitive skills both predict student achievement, but how they combine at the margin remains less settled. Using longitudinal data from Ireland and OLS interaction models with baseline controls, I examine how attentional regulation and cognitive ability jointly predict lower-secondary school-leaving examination achievement in Maths and English. The cognition $\times$ attentional regulation interaction is negative and significant for both subjects. The marginal return to cognitive ability is substantially larger for students with weaker behavioural regulation than for those with stronger regulation. The result survives multiple-testing correction, design-effect-inflated inference, and cross-informant validation. As a contrast, I compare these results against a broader personality proxy. Under this alternative, the interaction is weak and imprecise. This suggests that conclusions about how cognitive and noncognitive skills combine depend on the behavioural content of the noncognitive measure. The results indicate that attentional regulation and cognitive ability appear to function as compensating co-inputs in predicting later academic achievement.

When Do Gender Gaps in Maths Become Skill Gaps? Evidence from Ireland

Abstract: Research on gender differences in Maths achievement has documented persistent gaps, but most studies examine the gap at a single point in time and say little about whether its composition changes as children develop. This paper asks how the structure

of the gender gap in Maths differs between late childhood and early adolescence. Using longitudinal data from Ireland and Oaxaca-Blinder decompositions of the same college-entrance exam outcome with predictors measured in primary school (age 9) and secondary school (age 13), I find that the gap shifts from coefficient-dominant (driven by differences in how similar skills map into outcomes) to endowment-dominant (driven by differences in measured skills themselves) across this transition: in late childhood, boys and girls have similar measured skills but those skills map differently into outcomes; by early adolescence, measured skill differences account for most of the gap. I provide an English comparison as an internal benchmark and find that the pattern reverses by subject, with girls' advantage remaining coefficient-dominant even when boys hold stronger measured endowments. Additional distributional decompositions show that average differences mask substantial concentration in the middle of the score distribution. A secondary extension examines father absence under stricter measurement and attrition constraints.

Work in Progress

Educational Repercussions of the Great East Japan Earthquake

A Comparative Analysis of Shadow Education Policies and Outcomes in East Asia (2009-2023)

A Critical Examination of Educational Redshirting Research

Financial Aid, Educational Choice, and Student Outcomes During the Great Recession

Public Engagement & Writing

- **Founder & Author, *The DiD Digest* (diddigest.xyz)**

A newsletter translating advanced causal inference and econometric methods for researchers, policymakers, and industry professionals. I synthesize cutting-edge Difference-in-Differences research and methodological advances, making them accessible while maintaining technical rigor. The newsletter has reached 1,956 subscribers and 55.9K all-time views; audience spans 45 U.S. states and 92 countries (largest shares: U.S. 36%, U.K. 7%, India 6%, Germany 5%, Brazil 5%). Supported by a \$10,000 Emergent Ventures grant.

Selected Conferences & Workshops

Conferences

2026:	11th LEER Conference on Education Economics , Leuven, Belgium <i>(Invited)</i>
2026:	Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education , Lisbon, Portugal <i>(Invited)</i>
2025:	International Doctoral Forum , Beijing, China
2025:	Public Choice Outreach Conference 2025 , Fairfax, USA
2025:	ISWE Conference on Diversity, Economics and Society , Dublin, Ireland
2025:	ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement , London, UK
2025:	Young Economists' Meeting 2025 , Brno, Czech Republic <i>(Invited)</i>
2025:	10th LEER Conference on Education Economics , Leuven, Belgium
2024:	Growing Up In Ireland Annual Conference , Dublin, Ireland
2024:	Progress Conference 2024: Toward Abundant Futures , Berkeley, USA
2024:	Causal Inference OCE Conference III , Chicago, USA
2024, 2023, 2022:	Irish Economic Association Annual Conference

Summer Schools and Workshops

2024:	AV's Difference-in-Differences Workshop , San Francisco, USA <i>Supported by Arnold Ventures</i>
2024:	ISEG Summer School: Machine Learning for Prediction and Causal Analysis , Lisbon, Portugal
2024:	Optimization-Conscious Econometrics Summer School , Chicago, USA <i>Supported by University of Chicago's Kenneth C. Griffin Dept. of Economics</i>

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Emergent Ventures Grant (for DiD Digest)	<i>2025–2026</i>
ISWE Mentorship Program Participant	<i>2025–2026</i>
AMIE Mentoring Program Participant	<i>2024–2025</i>
UCD School of Economics Scholarship	<i>2020–2025</i>

Teaching Experience

Public Choice	Lecturer, Dublin City University	<i>Spring 2025/26</i>
Econometrics (M.Sc.)	TA for Dr. Tiziana Brancaccio	<i>Autumn 2023/24</i>
Adv. Econometrics: Microeconometrics	TA for Dr. Nora Strecker	<i>Spring 2023/24</i>
Intermediate Macroeconomics	TA for Dr. Yota Deli	<i>Spring 2022/23</i>
Macroeconomics for Business	Tutor for Dr. Ivan Pastine	<i>Autumn 2021/22</i>
Microeconomics for Business	TA for Dr. David Madden	<i>Spring 2020/21</i>
Game Theory	TA for Dr. Lucy Xinyang Liu	<i>Autumn 2020/21</i>
Industrial Economics	TA for Dr. Lucy Xinyang Liu	<i>Autumn 2020/21</i>
Physics and General Science	High School Teacher	<i>2014–2016</i>

Additional Information

Citizenship	Brazil, Italy
Programming Skills	R, Python, Stata, Matlab, L ^A T _E X, HTML, Claude Code, Codex
Languages	Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced), Korean (conversational), Japanese (beginner)
Policy Interests	Labour market policy, social protection design, education policy, evidence-informed public decision-making